Centennial PS School Council
March 22, 2023. 6:30-8:00 pm

In Attendance

Steve Sherlock, Heidi Holmes, Christine Glidden, Harish Pawagi, Julie Turner, Bashir Banjoko, Jenna Ferguson, Nima Hashi, Naci

Principal's Report – Stephen Sherlock

• We are in staffing season right now (planning for staffing for the next school year) • Right now we are using technology to support learning. In math students are exploring translations and rotations. In addition, students are learning coding.
• We are trying to strike balance between tech assisted learning and pen/paper tasks • Grade 8 grad pictures are on March 23rd

Teacher's Report – Nima Hashi

- Math
    - In Math, we have embarked on Data Management, with focus on misleading graphs. We will be creating a biased infographic, as a cumulative activity!
    - In 7-1, 7-2, 7-3, 7-4, 7-5, 7-6, 7-7, 7-8 we have been working on finding the area of a variety of shapes. Students are then applying these skills to find the volume and surface area of prisms and cylinders :)

- Core
    - In Core, Grade 7s are learning about persuasive speaking in their "rant" project, and are writing a biography on a brilliant black Canadian. We are excited to explore collaborative literacy through our book clubs discussions.

- Science
    - Grade 7s are learning about different types of structures, explored centre of gravity and currently learning about different types of forces that act on structures by creating and presenting skits on 6 different types of forces.
    - Grade 8s have completed their science fair projects and presented them in class. Some of these students are also creating display boards for our Grade 8 Science Fair in the gym on Thursday, March 2nd. We have many U of W ungrad and graduate students coming to judge these projects during the day and help select projects to advance to the WWSEF (Waterloo Wellington Science and Engineering Fair) on April 11 2023. ○ Grade 8s are also completing their Systems unit where they studied forces (inlcuding friction), mechanical advantage and eficiency using various simple machines. They will use this knowledge in the design and build of Mouse Trap cars in the construction room.

- Art
    - Grade eight Visual Arts students are diving into the creation of abstract faces using

mixed media.

- Music
    - Grade 7 Strings students (7-2, 7-4, 7-5, 7-7) have reviewed music theory and have been assigned a string instrument. They are beginning to learn how to set up and hold their instruments!
    - Grade 7 Band students (7-1, 7-3, 7-6, 7-8) have learned how to assemble, disassemble, clean, and care for their assigned Band instrument. They are reviewing music theory and are learning how to make a consistent sound on their mouthpieces!
    - Communication: A Welcome Letter and Parent/Guardian Instrument Sign-out Agreement will be sent home via School-Day. The Sign-out Agreement must be completed digitally (via Google Form) before students can sign out their instruments to practice at home.
        - Extra-curriuculars: Grade 8 Band, Grade 8 Orchestra, and Centennials Singers are currently rehearsing weekly during Nutrition Break. Band Drop-in and Strings Drop-in are also held once weekly at break for students who desire additional practice time.

- Gym/Health
    - No Updates

- French
    - In Core French, we have completed a research project on Francophonie countries. We are currently participating in an international music unit and will start work on planning a virtual field trip.
    - In Grade 8 French Immersion, students are listening to and working with songs in French as part of the “Manie Musicale”, a month-long competition between francophone artists and songs. (In Gr. 7 immersion as well!)

- Enrichment
    - Students from the enrichment programs participated in the Pascal and Cayley math contests from the University of Waterloo this week. This challenged them to use their mathematical knowledge to answer a variety of questions with content up to grade 9 material! The students were up to the challenge! This is a practice round for the Gauss contest in May which focuses on grade 7 and 8 mathematical challenges.
    - Students in language enrichment are continuing to work on writing novels. They are currently focusing on creating settings that reveal the personalities of the characters in their books.

- Guidance
    - Grade 8 students have been transferred to their correct high schools. Course selection planning has started. The course selection website, myBlueprint, will be open to grade 8 students from Fri. Feb 24th to Thurs. March 9th so students can complete and submit their courses online. Mrs. Spoltore has been in the grade 8 classrooms several times this year (including this week) to ensure students are ready and understand the course

selection process. All information shared during the class visits has been posted on the Grade 8 Centennial Support Services google classroom. Most students are already very comfortable with myBlueprint so we are in good shape!

- Any other cool/exciting things happening at school!
    - We have over 50 signatures from students who are hoping for a ping pong club at Centennial. We have a fundraising activity planned, but since our school has so many fundraising activities happening, we thought that we would first ask Parent Council for a donated table, or possibly some funding?
    - Some students are voluntarily participating in the Forest of Reading Programs which is available for all students to join. This year we are running Red Maple (10 Fiction), Yellow Cedar (10 Non Fiction), prix tamarac (10 french fiction). With at least 5 out of 10 books read from each program, allows students to vote the last week of April for their favourite. Authors really appreciate their target audience having a voice!
    - The first edition of The Centennial Scoop, our school newspaper, was published last month via a Google Site. Students who are part of this group are working hard on our second edition, which should be out soon!
    - Centennial's Drama Club is busy working on putting on a production of Alice in Wonderland! We have started the audition process today, which is really exciting!!

Student Report

- There was no student present to deliver a report during this meeting.

WRAPSC Update – Heidi Holmes

- There was no meeting in March
- Next meeting is Tuesday April 4th (speakers from the OSSTF, from OK2BMe, and also associate WRDSB direction Scott Miller)
- The topic will be: How to best work with school admin

Treasurer Update - Harish

- As of March 20th we have $22,000; pending withdrawals (for gagaball, music expenses, phys ed equipment, graduation expenses, and for the sound system).
- Pizza Days revenue has been about 17k with expenses of 7k; its about 50% profit • This means we have 13k funds in the account after we account for commitments, and we usually hold 3k as a buffer, which would mean about 10k in available funds

Pizza Days

- A parent asked if we could do blocks of 4 weeks vs 7, in case you miss the deadline. • Pizza Days have been very popular and a very good fundraising activity.
- We have hit our stride; we know how many to order and we are ordering extra to accommodate same day orders as well as students who don't have the funds to pay for the pizza. • This may be impacted by Ramadan and fasting. We may want to reduce how many we order (March 23rd is the

first day of fasting and it goes to April 21st)

- Bashir asked if the block orders be modified to take Ramadan into account. Heidi suggests crediting families who are in that situation. If you are in this situation, please reach out to the school for accommodation.
- Next year, we should take Ramadan into account for the block orders, and have one block for Ramadan only.

PRO Grant Proposal – Heidi Holmes

- Parents Reaching Out Grant – The Board distributes/allocates to school to allow schools to engage parents in education
- This year is later than normal. The deadline was in February and we submitted an application at that time
- We are partnering with Carizon for our event (an outdoor BBQ at Carizon's facility) • The topics will be about improving communication between parents and the school ○ It will focus on using Google Classroom and School Day along with the school's website. ○ It will also talk about how to contact the school, how to find out who your child's teacher is and how to contact them, etc.
    - We plan to provide written materials in multiple languages, with the intention that these could be reused in future years
- We applied for $500
- BBQ Type of Event planned as food draws people to attend
- Heidi met with Jordan W from Carizon, who is supportive. Jordan has done many of these types of events and Carizon has a lot of equipment that we can leverage (BBQs, propane tanks, plates, forks, etc.). We would provide the food and the labour for preparing and serving the food.
- Event will be Thursday May 18th with May 25th is the rain date (it will run from 5:30pm-7:30pm) ○ It will be hosted at Carizon
    - It is located in a Townhouse and there's a community area with basketball hoops where they typically set up
- Volunteer Opportunities
    - Looking for 4 people to help
    - Need someone to purchase food (pre-cooked items for food safety reasons)
    - Fruit, chips, hot dogs, hamburgers; we will need Halal options for food
    - Jordan may have someone to help cook
    - We need school council reps to attend the event and promote it
    - Students could be invited who speak the languages we are supporting
    - Need to make sure get parental support and permission for the student to participate
    - Print Resource
        - We also need a volunteer to develop a print resource
        - Resource will cover how to use school day, how to use google classroom, along with a quick summary of how to find a teacher on the website
        - Looking for a 1 page handout (perhaps double-sided)
    - Translation
        - We would like to translate into Arabic and any other language that's common to the school. To work with the teacher resource who supports our multi lingual

students to determine the languages which would be appropriate.

- There is a board resource that can sometimes help with translation services if they get it far enough in advance
- If you can help with translation, please reach out to Heidi.
- We could also possibly engage a local mosque to advertise and for support - The Coalition of Muslim Women could be an ally in planning and translation; Heidi to reach out
- Heidi to also ask Jordan W for input into the top languages for people he is supporting at Carizon

• Carizon will advertise on their regular Wednesday events and on their communication channels • Heidi motioned that if we are not successful with the PRO grant, school council will provide the $500 we should have received from the PRO grant, in addition will provide an additional $250 for the event (regardless of whether or not our PRO grant application is successful). That is, that council commits to covering up to $750 for the event, of which up to $500 may be from the PRO grant. Harish seconded, the majority voted in favour and the motion passed. • There was a suggestion to use technology to demonstrate, and whether or not we might have power available for these demos. Heidi suggested using portable items like phones to demo the website.

• Right now only 70% of families are on school day

- One issue is that you can only have one address per student; Harish to raise this with School Day
- A possible solution is to set up a forwarding rule from the mail account that receives the email so it goes to any other guardian(s)
- We want to get more families to sign up, and promote what's available on School Day

• With regard to Google Classroom and getting notifications for your children
- Heidi found a good video with captions and translations
- The resource should cover getting the Google Classroom codes. Do we need a list of these?
- This helps parents to engage in what is going on in class

• School Website

- Need to provide information about finding teachers, and finding their contact information (email address)
- It was suggested we include a QR code for the document link, website link, etc.

• A concern was raised about food safety with a BBQ, and a council member wondered if the volunteers from Carizon food safety certified. Heidi said they've run many of these events in the past and that we always use pre-cooked food items to avoid issues with food safety. • How will we know how many people are coming?

- We could ask for RSVPs (EventBrite?)
- We could also ask Jordan for his expectations for attendance for this event • There are possible vendors nearby who might provide donations including: Dairy Queen, Kernals, and M&M Meats. Need a volunteer to try to get donations on behalf of this event. Please reach out to Heidi if you are interested.

Next Meetings: April 26, May 24 from 6:30-8 pm